lot in the past few decades. Machine learning has found applications in a variety of new fields and smart personal assistant applications have become almost as common as smartphones. But robots, especially humanoids need strong AI to process, and act on the information they have collected. A smarter AI will mean better human robot interactions, better and faster learning and maybe even conscious robots one day.

- No single common platform exists. There are a number of startups, big-shots as well as individuals in the technology industry who are working in the field of robotics, but none of these projects are compatible with each other. Most of the times technology breakthroughs are not shared within the industry in fear of losing out to their competition.
- Power supply is still a problem. Most of the robots today are powered by heavy batteries that not only need to be recharged quite often but are very heavy leading to many design problems too. Alternate sources of powering up these robots need to be looked into and developed.

There are a number of ethical problems too which need to be looked at – if not right now then sometime soon at least. What things are robots allowed to do? Where exactly can we replace humans with robots? What are the basic rules that every robot should adhere to?

The future of robotics looks exciting and promising. Technology is advancing at a never seen before rate. By the turn of the decade the number of active robots in use in various industries will increase by at least two folds. New industries like logistics, healthcare and utilities will start using more robots in the next 5-10 years to increase their efficiency. All this will also lead to increased job opportunities in the robotics industry and create a dearth of skilled engineers in the field.

All in all, the robotics industry has a bright future and you can expect to have a robot butler or maid to be in your house before the end of the next decade. Just don't ask them to call you Mr. Stark. d